

Zhichen Zeng

zhichenz@illinois.edu | +1-217-953-1340 | 201 N. Goodwin Ave., #1119, Urbana, IL, 61801 | webpage | scholar

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Ph.D. in Computer Science; GPA: 4.0/4.0

IL, USA

Aug. 2023 – Aug. 2026 (expected)

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

M.S. in Computer Science; GPA: 4.0/4.0

IL, USA

Aug. 2021 – May. 2023

Zhejiang University

B.Eng. in Automation; GPA: 3.9/4.0

Zhejiang, China

Sept. 2016 – Jun. 2020

INTERNSHIP

Meta Platforms Inc.

Research Scientist Intern, Ranking & Foundational AI

CA, USA

May 2025 – Aug. 2025

Meta Platforms Inc.

Research Scientist Intern, Ranking & Foundational AI

CA, USA

May 2024 – Nov. 2024

ByteDance Ltd.

Machine Learning Engineer, Ads Core

Beijing, China

Jul. 2020 – Jun. 2021

PUBLICATIONS

1. **Zeng Z***, Yu Q*, Lin X, Qiu R, Ning X, Wei T, Yan Y, He J, Tong H. Harnessing Model Consistency for Robust Test-Time LLM Ensemble. EACL 2026.
2. **Zeng Z**, Qiu R, Bao W, Wei T, Lin X, Yan Y, Abdelzaher TF, Han J, Tong H. Pave Your Own Path: Graph Gradual Domain Adaptation on Fused Gromov-Wasserstein Geodesics. TMLR.
3. Li Z*, **Zeng Z***, Lin X*, Fang F, Qu Y, Xu Z, Liu Z, Ning X, Wei T, Liu G, Tong H. Flow Matching Meets Biology and Life Science: A Survey. Nature Portfolio Journal (npj) Artificial Intelligence.
4. **Zeng Z***, Liu X*, Hang M*, Liu X*, Zhou Q, Yang C, Liu Y, Ruan Y, Chen L, Chen Y, Hao Y, Xu J, Nie J, Liu X, Zhang B, Wen W, Yuan S, Wang K, Chen WY, Han Y, Li H, Yang C, Long B, Yu PS, Tong H, Yang J. InterFormer: Effective Heterogeneous Interaction Learning in CTR Prediction. CIKM 2025 (AR: 30%).
5. **Zeng Z**, Qiu R, Xu Z, Liu Z, Yan Y, Wei T, Ying L, He J, Tong H. Graph Mixup on Approximate Gromov-Wasserstein Geodesics. ICML 2024 (AR: 27.5%).
6. **Zeng Z**, Du B, Zhang S, Xia Y, Liu Z, Tong H. Hierarchical Multi-Marginal Optimal Transport for Network Alignment. AAAI 2024 (AR: 23.75%).
7. **Zeng Z**, Zhu R, Xia Y, Zeng H, Tong H. Generative Graph Dictionary Learning. ICML 2023 (AR: 27.9%).
8. **Zeng Z**, Zhang S, Xia Y, Tong H. PARROT: Position-Aware Regularized Optimal Transport for Network Alignment. theWebConf 2023 (AR: 19.2%).
9. Yu Q*, **Zeng Z***, Yan Y, Ying L, Srikanth R, Tong H. Joint Optimal Transport and Embedding for Network Alignment. theWebConf 2025 (AR: 19.8%).
10. Yu Q, **Zeng Z**, Yan Y, Liu Z, Jing B, Qiu R, Azad A, Tong H. PLANETALIGN: A Comprehensive Python Library for Benchmarking Network Alignment ICLR 2026 (AR: 28.0%).
11. Zhang Y, Yu D, Ge T, Song L, **Zeng Z**, Mi H, Jiang N, Yu D. Improving LLM General Preference Alignment via Optimistic Online Mirror Descent. NeurIPS 2025 Spotlight (AR: 24.52%).
12. Ai M, Wei T, Chen Y, **Zeng Z**, Zhao R, Varatkar G, Rouhani G, Tang X, Tong H, He J. ResMoE: Parameter Compression for Pre-Trained Mixture-of-Experts Transformer via Residual Restoration. KDD 2025 (AR: 19%).
13. Lin X, Tang Z, Cong W, Hang M, Wang K, Wang Y, **Zeng Z**, Li T, Yoo H, Liu Z, Ning X, Qiu R, Chen W, Chang S, Jin R, Li H, Tong H. Mixture of Sequence: Theme-Aware Mixture-of-Experts for Long-Sequence Recommendation. theWebConf 2026.
14. Zheng L, Jing B, Li Z, **Zeng Z**, Wei T, Ai M, He X, Liu L, Fu D, You J, Tong H. PyG-SSL: A Graph Self-Supervised Learning Toolkit. CIKM 2025 (AR: 43.2%).
15. Liang M, Liu X, Li H, Jin R, Liu B, Suo Q, Zhou Q, Zhou S, Chen L, Zheng H, Li Z, Jiang S, Yang J, Xia X, Yang F, Badr Y, Wen E, Xu S, Chen H, Zhang Z, Nie J, Yang C, **Zeng Z**, Zhang W, Huang X, Li Q, Wang S, Lyu E, Lu W, Zhang R, Wang W, Rudy J, Hang M, Wang K. External Large Foundation Model: How to Efficiently Serve Trillions of Parameters for Online Ads Recommendation. theWebConf 2025 (AR: 19.8%).
16. Bao W, **Zeng Z**, Liu Z, Tong H, He J. Matcha: Mitigating Graph Structure Shifts with Test-Time Adaptation. ICLR 2025. (AR: 32.08%).

17. Liu Z, Qiu R, **Zeng Z**, Yoo H, Zhou D, Xu Z, Zhu Y, Weldemariam K, He J, Tong H. Class-Imbalanced Graph Learning without Class Rebalancing. ICML 2024 (AR: 27.5%).
18. Xu H, Yan Y, Wang D, Xu Z, **Zeng Z**, Abdelzaher TF, Han J, Tong H. SLOG: An Inductive Spectral Graph Neural Network Beyond Polynomial Filter. ICML 2024 (AR: 27.5%).
19. Liu Z, Qiu R, **Zeng Z**, Zhu Y, Hamann H, Tong H. AIM: Attributing, Interpreting, Mitigating Data-encoded Unfairness. KDD 2024 (AR: 20.0%).
20. Yoo H, **Zeng Z**, Kang J, Qiu R, Zhou D, Liu Z, Wang F, Xu C, Chan E, Tong H. Ensuring User-side Fairness in Dynamic Recommender Systems. theWebConf 2024 (AR: 21.1%).
21. Yan Y, Hu Y, Zhou Q, Liu L, **Zeng Z**, Chen Y, Pan M, Chen H, Das M, Tong H. PACER: Network Embedding From Positional to Structural. theWebConf 2024 (AR: 21.1%).
22. Xu Z, Qiu R, Chen Y, Chen H, Fan X, Pan M, **Zeng Z**, Das M, Tong H. Discrete-state Continuous-time Diffusion for Graph Generation. NeurIPS 2024 (AR: 25.8%).
23. **Zeng Z**, Ni D, Xiao G. Real-time heliostat field aiming strategy optimization based on reinforcement learning. Applied Energy (impact factor: 11.0).
24. **Zeng Z**, Ni D. Harvesting optimal operation strategies from historical data for solar thermal power plants using reinforcement learning. SolarPACES 2020 (Oral).

Preprint

25. **Zeng Z**, Bao W, Lin X, Qiu R, Wei T, Ning X, Yan Y, Luo C, Cheng X, He J, Tong H. Subspace Alignment for Vision-Language Model Test-time Adaptation.
26. **Zeng Z**, Hang M, Liu X, Liu X, Lin X, Qiu R, Wei T, Liu Z, Yuan S, Yang C, Liu Y, Yin H, Yang J, Tong H. Hierarchical LoRA MoE for Efficient CTR Model Scaling.
27. Wei T, Li TW, Liu Z, Ning X, Yang Z, Zou J, **Zeng Z**, Qiu R, Lin X, Fu D, Li Z, et al. Agentic Reasoning for Large Language Models.
28. Cui C, Wei T, Chen Z, Qiu R, **Zeng Z**, Liu Z, Ning X, Zhou D, He J. AdaFuse: Adaptive Ensemble Decoding with Test-Time Scaling for LLMs.
29. Chen L, Qiu R, Yuan S, Liu Z, Wei T, Yoo H, **Zeng Z**, Yang D, Tong H. WAPITI: A Watermark for Finetuned Open-Source LLMs.
30. Liu X, **Zeng Z**, Liu X, Yuan S, Song W, Hang M, Liu Y, Yang C, Kim D, Chen WY, Yang J, Han Y, Jin R, Long B, Tong H, Yu PS. A Collaborative Ensemble Framework for CTR Prediction.
31. Lin X, **Zeng Z**, Wei T, Liu Z, Tong H. CATS: Mitigating Correlation Shift for Multivariate Time Series Classification.
32. Yan Y, Chen Y, Chen H, Li X, Xu Z, **Zeng Z**, Liu Z, Tong H. THEGCN: Temporal Heterophilic Graph Convolutional Network.

Under Review

33. Inference Scaling of LLM Ensembling: Bridging Token Spaces with Token Translation
34. ReMix: Reinforcement Routing for Mixtures of LoRAs in LLM Finetuning
35. Towards a Learnable Retriever for Textual Graph Question Answering
36. TSAQA: Time Series Analysis Question And Answering Benchmark

PROJECT EXPERIENCES

NetSafe: Towards a Computational Foundation of Safe Graph Neural Networks	NSF
<i>Research Assistant</i>	<i>Fall 2024 – Present</i>
Understanding Social Network-Transcendent Online/Offline Behavioral Dynamics	MURI
<i>Research Assistant</i>	<i>Spring 2024 – Present</i>
General-Purpose Scalable Technologies for Fundamental Graph Problems	NSF
<i>Research Assistant</i>	<i>Spring 2024 – Present</i>
Modeling Adversarial Activities	Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency
<i>Research Assistant</i>	<i>Fall 2021 – Present</i>
Machine Learning for Soil Health	NSF AI Institute for Agriculture
<i>Research Assistant</i>	<i>Fall 2022</i>
Multi-dimensional User Understanding on Graphs	Meta
<i>Research Assistant</i>	<i>Fall 2022</i>

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Conference reviewer: ICML, NeurIPS, ICLR, WWW, KDD, AAAI, IJCAI, CIKM, IEEE Big data
 Journal reviewer: TPAMI, TBD, TCBB